

ing a wad of magnesium powder by hand. Later, flash bulbs were provided, which contained magnesium filaments which were electrically ignited via a contact in the shutter. But these were strictly meant for single use.

In today's hi-tech world, flash units use electronic Xenon flash lamps, through which high voltage electric current is passed to produce a bright flash of light.

What is Flash Sync?

Flash Sync is short for 'Flash Synchronisation' and refers to a flash at the same moment that the shutter is fully open to admit light on to the image sensor inside. If it's a mechanical camera, the flash receives a message to fire through an electrical contact in the shutter mechanism. In the early days of photography, the camera had to be set to B (bulb) mode and the surroundings made completely dark. In digital cameras, an electronic timing circuit takes the message from a shutter contact. The sync terminals are wired to electrical contacts that complete the electrical circuit and fire the flash when the first shutter curtain fully opens. Other flash units known as 'optical slaves' are light triggered, and thus do not need an electrical connection to the main flash unit.



The electronic flash is an integral part of your digital camera